since its birth and were able to foresee and thwart devastating tragedies, beginning with the Bangladesh liberation. Gandhi believed in the highly resourceful R&AW and asked for an intelligence analysis on Fiji within twenty-four hours. In the meantime, Tiwari's ministry was asked to release a statement for the global media. The two-paragraph statement said:

The government of India are distressed to hear reports of the military seizing power in Fiji and taking the Prime Minister and members of his cabinet into custody. The overthrow of a government elected through popular mandate only recently and the abrogation of the constitution are disquieting developments. The government of India views these developments with deep concern. We hope that racial harmony in Fiji will be maintained and that all parties will whole-heartedly work for the speedy return of Parliamentary democracy in Fiji.

Gandhi cleared the statement for release. He was determined to generate international sympathy for the deposed government in Fiji.

Road to Perdition most serious threat to the island nation's stability. As the indigenous population, the Fijians had enjoyed protected status under colonial rules and the British had discriminated against the Indians. When the British granted Fiji independence, they ensured the inhabitants would repeat the bloody politics that the colonists had successfully engineered during the liberation of India. Before the final ship bearing the Union Jack sailed off the coast of Suva, the British had installed a pro-Western political front in Fiji—the Alliance Party headed by the elite Ratu Sir Kamisese Mara. He enjoyed the support of approximately two and a quarter lakh Fijians, while the two